



Portability lives in the artefacts you own

✓ **Abstract: thin, firm-owned**

where switching is likely and the interface is small

L5 Memory API
write · recall · forget by subject · snapshot

L6 Retrieval interface
one thin call returning IDs and scores

L7 Embed and rerank service
model version on every vector

L9 Telemetry collector
firm-owned, open, with redaction

L9 Evaluation datasets
datasets and scorers in source control

C1 Routing contract
one API contract at the gateway; no provider SDKs

C3 Privacy API
detect · transform · re-identify

C4 Policy as code
open policy language, with tests

C5 Configuration fetch
one call, with a file-based fallback

C7 Credentials
workload identity and a vault; no standing secrets

✗ **Do not over-abstract**

wrappers drift behind every upstream release

L1 Vendor model extras
only behind an adapter with a feature-free fallback

L3 Agent frameworks
no firm-wide wrapper: frameworks on top of frameworks. Keep specification, prompts, tools and evaluations outside, and a rewrite is bounded work

L3 Single-workflow plug-ins
one workflow with one model step needs no plug-in architecture

L6 Plain database access
no layer between every query and the database

L6-L7 Store-bundled features
use only if the model is pinned and raw text is kept outside; never abstract to hide an unpinned model

THE SIGNAL

Framework currency

days behind the pinned framework's latest security fix, held inside the patch window (for example, 30 days)

MULTI-VENDOR IS NECESSARY

- two unrelated model vendors
- an open-weight exit route
- two red-team tools, one independent
- two gateway deployments
- two guardrail detectors

MULTI-VENDOR ONLY ADDS COMPLEXITY

- two orchestration frameworks
- a second cloud's agent stack
- two vector stores, one corpus
- two observability platforms
- two identity providers for agents